

THE TUGHLAQs: MUHAMMAD BIN TUGHLAQ & FIRUZ SHAH

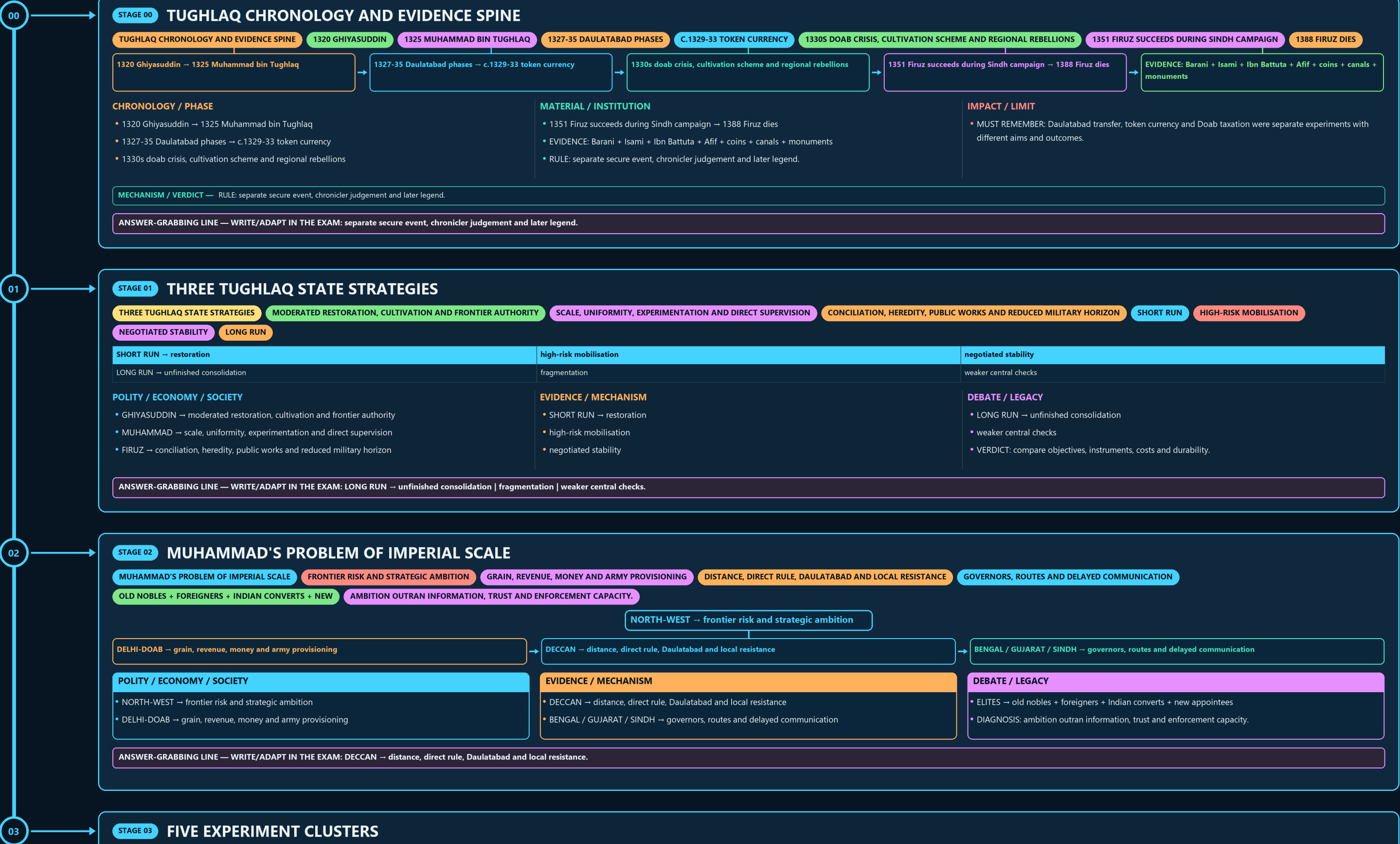
TUGHLAQ CHRONOLOGY AND EVIDENCE → THREE TUGHLAQ STATE STRATEGIES → MUHAMMAD’S PROBLEM OF IMPERIAL → FIVE EXPERIMENT CLUSTERS → DAULATABAD WITHOUT THE EMPTY-DELHI → TOKEN CURRENCY CREDIBILITY CHAIN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECCAN → distance, direct rule, Daulatabad and local resistance.

03

STAGE 03 FIVE EXPERIMENT CLUSTERS

FIVE EXPERIMENT CLUSTERS

SOUTHERN SUPERVISION

MIGRATION AND DUAL-CAPITAL LOGISTICS

TOKEN MONEY

MONETARY FLEXIBILITY

AUTHENTICATION AND REDEMPTION

DOAB RESET

HIGHER DEPENDABLE REVENUE

DAULATABAD → southern supervision

migration and dual-capital logistics

TOKEN MONEY → monetary flexibility

authentication and redemption

DOAB RESET → higher dependable revenue

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- DAULATABAD → southern supervision
- migration and dual-capital logistics
- TOKEN MONEY → monetary flexibility
- authentication and redemption

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- DOAB RESET → higher dependable revenue
- assessment and famine resilience
- DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI → cultivation
- credit and honest supervision

DEBATE / LEGACY

- KHURASAN / QARACHIL → frontier initiative
- finance, terrain and intelligence
- TEST EACH: rational aim → required instrument → implementation failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST EACH: rational aim → required instrument → implementation failure.

04

STAGE 04 DAULATABAD WITHOUT THE EMPTY-DELHI MYTH

DAULATABAD WITHOUT THE EMPTY-DELHI MYTH

SECOND CAPITAL + DECCAN SUPERVISION + NORTH-SOUTH COMMUNICATION

COURT + OFFICIALS + NOBLES + SCHOLARS/SUFIS + MERCHANTS/ARTISANS

PRESSURED MOVEMENT AND HARDSHIP REMAINED REAL

DELHI RETAINED PEOPLE, MINTING AND POLITICAL FUNCTION

RETURN AND SOUTHERN BREAKAWAYS CHANGED THE PROJECT'S PURPOSE

SOURCE RULE

ISAMI'S DISPLACEMENT NARRATIVE IS VITAL BUT POSITIONED.

OBJECTIVE → second capital + Deccan supervision + north-south communication

AFFECTED → court + officials + nobles + scholars/Sufis + merchants/artisans

COERCION → pressured movement and hardship remained real

CONTINUITY → Delhi retained people, minting and political function

REVERSAL → return and southern breakaways changed the project's purpose

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- OBJECTIVE → second capital + Deccan supervision + north-south communication
- AFFECTED → court + officials + nobles + scholars/Sufis + merchants/artisans

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COERCION → pressured movement and hardship remained real
- CONTINUITY → Delhi retained people, minting and political function

DEBATE / LEGACY

- REVERSAL → return and southern breakaways changed the project's purpose
- SOURCE RULE → Isami's displacement narrative is vital but positioned.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOURCE RULE → Isami's displacement narrative is vital but positioned.

05

STAGE 05 TOKEN CURRENCY CREDIBILITY CHAIN

TOKEN CURRENCY CREDIBILITY CHAIN

STATE ASSIGNS COPPER

BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE SUCCESS REQUIRES MINT CONTROL

PRIVATE IMITATION AND COUNTERFEIT EXPANSION TRUST COLLAPSES

REDEMPTION BURDEN

MONETARY DESIGN FAILED THROUGH ENFORCEMENT AND CREDIBILITY GAPS.

STATE ASSIGNS COPPER / BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE success requires mint control + recognisable

tax acceptance weak verification → private imitation and counterfeit expansion trust collapses → redemption burden

LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- STATE ASSIGNS COPPER / BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE success requires mint control + recognisable standard +
- tax acceptance weak verification → private imitation and counterfeit expansion trust collapses → redemption burden → withdrawal

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.
- STATE ASSIGNS COPPER / BRASS A HIGHER FACE VALUE success requires mint control + recognisable standard +

DEBATE / LEGACY

- tax acceptance weak verification → private imitation and counterfeit expansion trust collapses → redemption burden → withdrawal
- LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON: monetary design failed through enforcement and credibility gaps.

06

STAGE 06 DOAB CRISIS AND AGRARIAN REPAIR

DOAB CRISIS AND AGRARIAN REPAIR

STANDARD YIELD

OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND HARSH COLLECTION + FAMINE

FLIGHT, RESISTANCE AND REBELLION

SONDHAR LOANS + DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI CULTIVATION PROGRAMME CORRUPTION, WEAK MONITORING

SEPARATE FISCAL OBJECTIVE, COLLECTOR BEHAVIOUR AND CLIMATE.

STANDARD YIELD / OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND harsh collection + famine stress → flight

SONDHAR loans + DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI cultivation programme corruption, weak monitoring and over-ambitious scale limit recovery

RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- STANDARD YIELD / OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND harsh collection + famine stress → flight, resistance and rebellion

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.
- STANDARD YIELD / OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND harsh collection + famine stress → flight, resistance and rebellion

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SONDHAR loans + DIWAN-I-AMIR-I-KOHI cultivation programme corruption, weak monitoring and over-ambitious scale limit recovery

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POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.
- STANDARD YIELD / OFFICIAL PRICE + HIGH DEMAND harsh collection + famine stress → flight, resistance and rebellion

DEBATE / LEGACY

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- RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE: separate fiscal objective, collector behaviour and climate.

07

STAGE 07

KHURASAN AND QARACHIL SEPARATED

KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION NORTH-WEST STRATEGIC OPENING HIMALAYAN FRONTIER

COMMON LIMIT

STRATEGIC AMBITION EXCEEDED SUSTAINABLE LOGISTICS.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply	COMMON LIMIT: strategic ambition exceeded sustainable logistics.	problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China
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POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply
- problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- COMMON LIMIT: strategic ambition exceeded sustainable logistics.
- KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply

DEBATE / LEGACY

- problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China
- COMMON LIMIT: strategic ambition exceeded sustainable logistics.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: KHURASAN PROJECT QARACHIL EXPEDITION north-west strategic opening Himalayan frontier campaign large recruited force terrain and supply problem changed external conditions severe operational losses not simply world conquest not an invasion of China.

08

STAGE 08

READING THE TUGHLAQ ARCHIVE

POLICY DETAIL AND ELITE CRITICISM

LATER, NORMATIVE, ARISTOCRATIC

DAULATABAD/DECCAN DISPLACEMENT

HOSTILE POLITICAL LOCATION

IBN BATTUTA

EYEWITNESS COURT/TRAVEL

DRAMATIC LITERARY CONVENTIONS

BARANI → policy detail and elite criticism	later, normative, aristocratic
ISAMI → Daulatabad/Deccan displacement	hostile political location
IBN BATTUTA → eyewitness court/travel	dramatic literary conventions
AFIF / FUTUHAT → Firuz institutions	praise and self-fashioning
LATER CHRONICLES → memory	cannot certify exact totals
COINS / CANALS / MONUMENTS → material checks	uneven survival

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BARANI → policy detail and elite criticism
- later, normative, aristocratic
- ISAMI → Daulatabad/Deccan displacement
- hostile political location
- IBN BATTUTA → eyewitness court/travel

METHOD / DEBATE

- dramatic literary conventions
- AFIF / FUTUHAT → Firuz institutions
- praise and self-fashioning
- LATER CHRONICLES → memory
- cannot certify exact totals

HISTORICAL RESULT

- COINS / CANALS / MONUMENTS → material checks
- uneven survival
- METHOD: intent + report + implementation + region + later stereotype.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: METHOD: intent + report + implementation + region + later stereotype.

09

STAGE 09

FIRUZ'S CONCILIATION BARGAIN

SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON NOBLE SALARIES AND LIGHTER AUDITS +

CLOSE DISTINCTION

FAILURE MUST NOT BE REDUCED TO A TIMELESS 'MAD

SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas

soldier wajh claims + ulema support + reduced punitive intensity short-term peace and

elite compliance long-term oligarchic closure, localised army and weaker central discipline.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Failure must not be reduced to a timeless 'mad king' label; design, enforcement

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- elite compliance long-term oligarchic closure, localised army and weaker central discipline.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas

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FIRUZ'S CONCILIATION BARGAIN

SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON NOBLE SALARIES AND LIGHTER AUDITS +

CLOSE DISTINCTION

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POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas

• soldier wajh claims + ulema support + reduced punitive intensity short-term peace and

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• elite compliance long-term oligarchic closure, localised army and weaker central discipline.

• CLOSE DISTINCTION: Failure must not be reduced to a timeless 'mad king' label; design, enforcement, ecology and source hostility matter.

DEBATE / LEGACY

• SMALLER GOVERNABLE HORIZON noble salaries and lighter audits + hereditary offices and iqtas

• soldier wajh claims + ulema support + reduced punitive intensity short-term peace and

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Failure must not be reduced to a timeless 'mad king' label; design, enforcement, ecology and source hostility matter.

STAGE 10

WORKS, WELFARE, SLAVERY AND ORTHODOXY

WORKS, WELFARE, SLAVERY AND ORTHODOXY

CULTIVATION AND REVENUE IN THE NORTHERN CORE

URBAN PATRONAGE AND DYNASTIC DISPLAY

BOUNDED WELFARE CLAIMS

EMPLOYMENT REPORTS

CHRONICLER EVIDENCE, NOT A MODERN LABOUR OFFICE

COERCED SERVICE AND LATER FACTIONAL RISK

ORTHODOXY WITH CASE-SPECIFIC EVIDENCE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CANALS / HAQQ-I-SHARB → cultivation and revenue in the northern core	EMPLOYMENT REPORTS → chronicler evidence, not a modern labour office	PILLARS / TRANSLATIONS → conservation, appropriation and learned exchange.
TOWNS / GARDENS / KOTLA → urban patronage and dynastic display	DIWAN-I-BANDAGAN → coerced service and later factional risk	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Firuz Shah's canals, charities, slavery and religious policy require a combined fiscal, social and political reading.
HOSPITAL / EDUCATION / DIWAN-I-KHAIRAT → bounded welfare claims	JIZYA / BRAHMANS / ULAMA → orthodoxy with case-specific evidence	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• CANALS / HAQQ-I-SHARB → cultivation and revenue in the northern core

• TOWNS / GARDENS / KOTLA → urban patronage and dynastic display

• HOSPITAL / EDUCATION / DIWAN-I-KHAIRAT → bounded welfare claims

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• EMPLOYMENT REPORTS → chronicler evidence, not a modern labour office

• DIWAN-I-BANDAGAN → coerced service and later factional risk

• JIZYA / BRAHMANS / ULAMA → orthodoxy with case-specific evidence

DEBATE / LEGACY

• PILLARS / TRANSLATIONS → conservation, appropriation and learned exchange.

• EVIDENCE LIMIT: Firuz Shah's canals, charities, slavery and religious policy require a combined fiscal, social and political reading.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Firuz Shah's canals, charities, slavery and religious policy require a combined fiscal, social and political reading.

STAGE 11

TOPIC 05 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 05 ANSWER SPINE

TUGHLAQ HISTORY IS A TEST OF STATE CAPACITY, NOT

GHIYASUDDIN'S RESTORATION AND AN UNUSUALLY LARGE INHERITED EMPIRE

AIM, INSTRUMENT, FAILURE MODE AND UNEVEN AFTERLIFE OF EACH

CONCILIATION, WORKS AND WELFARE BALANCED AGAINST HEREDITY AND ORTHODOXY

COMPARE CHRONICLERS WITH COINS, CANALS, INSCRIPTIONS AND MONUMENTS

OVER-CENTRALISATION AND NEGOTIATED DEVOLUTION PRODUCED DIFFERENT FRAGILITIES.

OPEN → Tughlaq history is a test of state capacity, not eccentricity alone

CONTEXT → Ghiyasuddin's restoration and an unusually large inherited empire

MUHAMMAD → aim, instrument, failure mode and uneven afterlife of each project

FIRUZ → conciliation, works and welfare balanced against heredity and orthodoxy

SOURCES → compare chroniclers with coins, canals, inscriptions and monuments

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• OPEN → Tughlaq history is a test of state capacity, not eccentricity alone

• CONTEXT → Ghiyasuddin's restoration and an unusually large inherited empire

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• MUHAMMAD → aim, instrument, failure mode and uneven afterlife of each project

• FIRUZ → conciliation, works and welfare balanced against heredity and orthodoxy

DEBATE / LEGACY

• SOURCES → compare chroniclers with coins, canals, inscriptions and monuments

• CLOSE → over-centralisation and negotiated devolution produced different fragilities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → over-centralisation and negotiated devolution produced different fragilities.

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE TUGHLAQs

MUHAMMAD BIN TUGHLAQ & FIRUZ SHAH — ADVANCED

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

• The Tughlaqs: Muhammad bin Tughlaq & Firuz Shah — ADVANCED

• Mini-timeline

• 1. Snapshot & core idea

• 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

• 3. Study links

• 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

• 5. UPSC Traps

• 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

• 7. Mains angles

• + Concept: "Second capital," not "capital transfer"

• The exodus to Deogiri/Daulatabad was not a total emptying of Delhi.

• It mainly involved the royal household, nobles, officials, Sufis, ulema, merchants and artisans

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

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